

IELTS WORKSHOP

THE FORUM CENTER - NGUYỄN HOÀNG HUY

TÀI LIỆU CHUYÊN ĐỀ SPEAKING

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PART 1

Gift

1. Have you ever received a great gift?

Main ideas:

- I was once gifted an unexpected weekend trip to a mountain resort.
- It was an incredibly thoughtful gesture from my partner during a stressful time.
- The experience was far more valuable than any tangible or material object.

I've been fortunate enough to receive several lovely presents, but one that truly stands out was an unexpected weekend getaway to a mountain resort. It was an incredibly thoughtful gesture from my partner during a particularly stressful period at work. To be honest, I found the experience to be far more valuable than any tangible or material object. The opportunity to unwind and disconnect from the digital world was exactly what I needed at that specific moment in time.

2. What gift have you received recently?

Main ideas:

- Most recently, I was given a sophisticated fountain pen by a mentor.
- It was presented to me as a token of appreciation upon my promotion.
- It's not just a writing tool; it symbolizes a new professional chapter.

3. Do you think you are good at choosing gifts?

Main ideas:

- I pride myself on being a discerning gift-giver who prioritizes personalization.
- I enjoy the process of "treasure hunting" to find a truly meaningful item.
- My goal is always to evoke a genuine emotional response from the recipient.

4. What do you consider when choosing a gift?

Main ideas:

- I primarily focus on the practical utility combined with the recipient's aesthetic preferences.
- I also contemplate the symbolic meaning behind the item to ensure it's appropriate.

- Ultimately, the level of intimacy in the relationship dictates the nature of the gift.
- Hobby

1. Do you have any hobbies?

Main ideas:

- I'm a firm believer in having diverse hobbies to maintain a work-life balance.
- My primary pursuit at the moment is long-distance running.
- It provides a sense of accomplishment and enhances my physical endurance.

I'm a firm believer in the importance of having diverse hobbies to maintain a healthy work-life balance. My primary pursuit at the moment is long-distance running, which I find incredibly therapeutic. It provides me with a profound sense of accomplishment and significantly enhances my physical endurance. Moreover, engaging in this activity outdoors allows me to reconnect with nature and clear my mind after a taxing day at the office. It's truly an indispensable part of my daily routine that keeps me motivated.

2. Did you have any hobbies when you were a child?

Main ideas:

- During my formative years, I was particularly fond of stamp collecting.
- I was fascinated by the intricate designs and historical significance of each piece.
- This hobby nurtured my curiosity about different cultures and global geography.

3. Do you have a hobby that you've had since childhood?

Main ideas:

- Painting is an artistic endeavor that has stayed with me since my youth.
- It has evolved from simple doodles to more complex oil painting techniques.
- It serves as a creative outlet that allows me to articulate my emotions.

4. Do you have the same hobbies as your family members?

Main ideas:

- Generally speaking, our recreational pursuits tend to diverge quite significantly.
- My siblings are gravitating toward high-intensity sports, whereas I prefer more sedentary activities.
- That said, we occasionally converge over our shared appreciation for classical music concerts.

SPEAKING PROMPT

Describe an occasion when you were not allowed to use your mobile phone - When it was - Where it was - Why you were not allowed to use your mobile phone - And how you felt about it

I'd like to recount an experience when I was strictly forbidden from utilizing my mobile phone during a digital detox workshop I attended last autumn. This retreat was nestled in a remote mountainous region, specifically designed to offer a sanctuary away from the relentless buzz of urban life.

The rationale behind this stringent policy was to facilitate deep meditation and cultivate mental clarity. Upon arrival, all participants were required to surrender their electronic devices to the organizers. The philosophy was that true introspection is impossible when one is constantly bombarded by digital interruptions and the addictive nature of social media algorithms. Therefore, for seventy-two hours, I was completely cut off from the virtual world.

Initially, I grappled with "phantom vibration syndrome," where I mistakenly thought my phone was buzzing in my pocket. It was a stark realization of how tethered I had become to technology. However, this discomfort eventually gave way to a profound sense of psychological liberation. I felt exceptionally rejuvenated, having rediscovered the joy of uninterrupted thought and authentic face-to-face interaction. Ultimately, the experience was transformative, leaving me with a newfound appreciation for setting boundaries with my digital consumption.

PART 3**1. Do you think it is necessary to have laws on the use of mobile phones?**

Undoubtedly, the introduction of legislation governing mobile phone usage is imperative to safeguard public welfare. Beyond the obvious prohibition of handheld devices while operating a vehicle, laws are crucial for protecting intellectual property and ensuring privacy in restricted zones. Such regulations act as a necessary deterrent against behaviors that could jeopardize lives or compromise sensitive information. While some argue for personal freedom, the collective benefits of maintaining order and safety in our increasingly digitized society far outweigh the minor inconveniences of these legal restrictions.

2. Is it a waste of time to take pictures with mobile phones?

I believe that whether taking photos is a waste of time is entirely subjective and depends on one's intentions. For many, it's a valuable way of preserving the "ephemeral" moments of life that would otherwise be forgotten. However, the modern obsession with curating a perfect online persona often leads to a superficial engagement with reality. When the primary motivation is seeking external validation through "likes," the act of photography certainly detracts from the authentic experience. Balancing documentation with presence is key to ensuring it remains a meaningful activity.

3. What positive and negative impact do mobile phones have on friendship?

Mobile phones exert a dual influence on contemporary friendships. On a positive note, they facilitate "perpetual contact," enabling friends to provide emotional support instantaneously across borders. Conversely, the prevalence of digital communication can lead to the erosion of face-to-face social skills. The constant barrage of notifications often interrupts the flow of natural dialogue, resulting in fragmented and less fulfilling interactions. Ultimately, while technology provides the tools for connectivity, it simultaneously threatens the depth and quality of physical companionship if not managed with a high degree of mindfulness.

Từ vựng

Từ vựng (Từ loại)	/Phiên âm/	Nghĩa tiếng Anh (Giải thích tiếng Việt)	Ví dụ minh họa

THE
FORUM